

TERRY ROBAR

Senior Sales & Operations Executive

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CONTACT

SNAPSHOT

25+ years in sales leadership, retail transformation, and commercial growth

Grew an appliance retailer from ~1% to 8.8% national market share, scaling it to a mid nine-figure operation across 36 locations

Led 300+ sales professionals nationally across 7 provinces

Founder of Elev8 Talent Agency and Tackline Strategies — operating both ventures in parallel

CORE EXPERTISE

- National Sales Leadership
- P&L & Commercial Performance
- Retail Transformation & Scaling
- Multi-Site & Field Operations
- Omni-Channel & Digital Sales
- Vendor & Manufacturer Relations
- Pricing, Margin & Promotion Strategy
- Commission & Compensation Design
- Sales Training & Performance Mgmt.
- AI & Automation Architecture
- Venture Building & Franchise Models
- Executive & Board Reporting
- M&A Integration & New Market Entry
- Strategic Partnerships & BD

SECTOR EXPERIENCE

- Major Appliances
- Furniture & High-Ticket Retail
- Consumer Electronics & Telecom
- Building & Trade Channel
- Commercial / Builder Sales
- SaaS — Telecom & Communications
- Recruiting & Talent Solutions
- Media & Advertising

TECHNOLOGY

- HubSpot, QuickBooks, Stripe
- OpenAI / AI-Powered Workflows
- CRM & Sales Performance Dashboards

- Live Chat & Virtual Sales Platforms
- POS, Inventory & Pricing Systems
- Lead Routing & Automation
- Microsoft Office, Teams, Power BI

EDUCATION

Loyalist College

Diploma of Advertising

Belleville, Ontario

RECOGNITION

Youngest Sales Manager in The Brick's history at time of promotion

Featured commentary in CBC, City News, LiveChat, and Newswire on omni-channel retail and appliance industry strategy

Canadian Appliance Source — Growth 500 (No. 135, 2019)

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Sales Leadership · Retail Transformation · Commercial Growth

Senior sales and operations executive with 25+ years building national sales infrastructures and leading commercial transformations across high-ticket retail, SaaS, and emerging service categories. As President of Sales at Canadian Appliance Source, helped grow the company from a sub-1% share of the Canadian appliance market to 8.8% national share — taking it from a six-figure regional operator to a mid nine-figure national platform across 36 locations and 7 provinces. Built the sales operating system, leadership bench, vendor partnerships, and omni-channel programs that supported sustained, profitable share capture.

Currently leads two parallel ventures: Elev8 Talent Agency, a cross-border recruiting and talent solutions platform built on AI-powered systems and franchise-style expansion infrastructure; and Tackline Strategies, a consulting firm advising retail and SaaS clients on revenue architecture, commercial transformation, partnerships, and operating performance.

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS AT A GLANCE

8.8%

National Market Share

36

Locations Built

300+

Sales Pros Led

57%

National Close Rate

SIGNATURE ACHIEVEMENTS

- Captured national market share at scale. Helped grow Canadian Appliance Source from a sub-1% share of the Canadian appliance market to 8.8% — taking the business from a six-figure regional operator to a mid nine-figure national platform across 36 locations and 7 provinces. Built the sales structure, leadership bench, training discipline, and operating systems that supported the entire trajectory.
- Built new revenue divisions from zero. Launched the Trade Incentive Program (interior designers, custom builders, property managers), scaling it from \$0 to eight figures. Stood up the Commercial Division (high-rise, mid-rise, infill, tract builders) from \$0 to \$5M in 8 months and ultimately to eight figures.
- Designed a national sales operating system. Created the SOPs, structured sales journey, training curriculum, KPI framework, and lead-routing automation that drove a 57% national close rate — a benchmark result in big-ticket retail.
- Pioneered omni-channel selling in the appliance category. Repositioned live chat from a support function into a primary sales channel, contributing 200%+ growth and a nine-figure revenue stream. Built a video-based remote selling platform that became a seven-figure channel.

- Reshaped retail economics for an Ontario operator. As lead consultant to Coast Appliances, delivered +40% same-store sales, \$700K+ in annual payroll savings, and seven-figure incremental national revenue through omni-channel expansion — while holding full P&L ownership and standardizing operations across 19 locations.
- Transformed an early-stage SaaS company into a revenue-driven business. Led go-to-market redesign, built tiered pricing and a free-trial conversion funnel, and launched partner-led distribution with Zendesk, Aircall, and others — producing a 30% ARR increase and investor-ready positioning.
- Engineered private-label and OEM product strategy. Designed an exclusive private-label appliance line (ventilation, ranges, refrigeration) sourced through overseas manufacturing partners — improving margin profile and reducing reliance on external brands.
- Controlled and deployed a \$10M+ annual marketing budget. Directed national multi-channel campaigns (print, radio, billboard, digital, in-store), aligned vendor MDF, and tied marketing investment directly to sales conversion and inventory turnover.
- Recognized for rapid advancement. Became the youngest Sales Manager in The Brick's history at time of promotion; later promoted to Store Manager and grew a 'C'-classification store to 'B' classification through team development and operational discipline.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Elev8 Talent Agency Cross-Border (Canada / United States)

Founder & Managing Partner July 2025 – Present

Founded a cross-border recruiting and talent solutions company built around AI-powered systems, automation, and franchise-style expansion infrastructure. Designed and operationalized the entire business — corporate structure, technology stack, recruiter enablement systems, compensation architecture, and scalable operating model — from the ground up.

- Cross-border corporate structure. Established multiple Canadian and U.S. corporate entities to support scalable recruiting operations, independent recruiter partnerships, and agency growth — including the legal, financial, and operational architecture required to operate across both jurisdictions.
- AI-powered training & enablement ecosystem. Designed and built a self-guided recruiter training and onboarding platform leveraging OpenAI technologies — covering recruiting methodology, sales process, candidate communication, and operational systems. Enables recruiters to onboard, learn, and ramp without dependency on live trainers.
- Full business systems stack. Integrated HubSpot (CRM and sales pipeline), QuickBooks (accounting and receivables), Stripe (billing and payments), OpenAI (training and automation), and a connected ecosystem of tools to streamline lead generation, business development, candidate management, billing, and operational reporting.
- Recruiter operating system. Built standardized SOPs, onboarding frameworks, client acquisition processes, candidate management workflows, branding standards, policy manuals, and operational playbooks — engineered for consistency across independent recruiters, teams, and small recruiting firms.
- Commission & compensation architecture. Designed tiered commission structures, override frameworks, revenue-sharing models, and performance-based incentives supporting independent recruiter retention and scalable agency growth.
- Franchise-style expansion model. Developed a market-expansion package with operational systems, recruiter leadership pathways, territory frameworks, and standardized development infrastructure designed to support geographic scaling across multiple markets.
- Automation & lifecycle workflows. Built automated email campaigns, lead-nurturing sequences, recruiter onboarding flows, candidate engagement systems, and client follow-up workflows — turning manual touchpoints into CRM-driven, repeatable processes.
- Productized service offering. Packaged the platform so independent recruiters, recruiting teams, and small-to-mid-sized staffing firms can plug into Elev8's infrastructure, automation, and AI-enhanced workflows rather than building it themselves.

Tackline Strategies Inc. Toronto, ON

Co-Founder & President 2022 – Present

Co-founded a consulting firm specializing in sales optimization, commercial transformation, and revenue architecture for high-ticket retail and SaaS clients. Engagements span go-to-market strategy, pricing design, partnerships, and field execution.

SELECTED CLIENT ENGAGEMENTS:

Coast Appliances — National Appliance Retailer · 19 locations · ~18-month engagement

Retained to execute a dual-track transformation: drive immediate revenue and profitability growth in Ontario retail, and modernize the national retail model into a scalable, omni-channel, performance-driven organization. Held full P&L ownership of Ontario retail operations with national alignment responsibility across all 19 locations.

- Revenue growth & market expansion. Increased same-store retail sales by 40% year-over-year and contributed seven-figure incremental national revenue. Implemented a segmented revenue model splitting retail (consumer), commercial (B2B), and emerging digital channels — redesigning the sales approach by segment to lift conversion and average transaction value.
- Live chat omni-channel build. Designed and deployed live chat as a primary revenue channel rather than a support function. Built the full sales process integration around digital engagement and enabled a showroom-to-customer remote selling model — turning live chat into a measurable, seven-figure sales engine inside an existing retail operation.
- Full P&L ownership — Ontario. Held end-to-end accountability for revenue, gross margin, payroll, and operating expenses against profitability targets. Implemented margin-focused sales strategies and balanced cost reduction with growth — delivering net profit expansion, not just top-line lift.
- National sales alignment. Partnered with District Managers across Canada to standardize the sales process, KPIs, reporting, and execution frameworks. Rolled out unified sales training, customer segmentation strategy, and centralized performance tracking across all 19 locations — eliminating regional inconsistencies.
- Operational cost reduction. Reduced payroll expenses by \$700K+ annually by realigning store staffing models and increasing productivity per sales associate. Renegotiated vendor agreements to lower operating costs and improve margin contribution.
- Retail network optimization. Led the closure of 2 underperforming locations and designed and executed the full liquidation strategy — inventory disposition, pricing, and sales execution — improving the profitability footprint across remaining stores.
- Final-mile & logistics restructuring. Sourced and onboarded a new national delivery partner. Introduced a restructured pricing model for final-mile delivery, reducing logistics cost while improving service alignment with the customer experience.

- Sales team build-out & coaching. Recruited, trained, and developed new high-performance sales teams. Operated at District Manager level, directly coaching teams and standardizing sales methodology across all locations.
- Compensation & talent strategy. Led a full commission structure redesign — competitive with the Ontario retail market, aligned to margin performance, sales behavior, and customer segmentation — improving attraction and retention of top talent.
- Marketing & go-to-market. Partnered with marketing to redesign the go-to-market strategy, increase in-store traffic and conversion, and align campaign spend with the new sales segmentation strategy.
- Systems, automation & infrastructure. Implemented an internal communication and operations platform housing SOPs, training materials, and KPI dashboards. Introduced automation workflows across communication, reporting, and operational consistency.
- Centralized improvement function. Hired and trained a National Improvement Manager — creating a centralized operational oversight role to sustain the transformation post-engagement.
- Executive & board-level strategy. Developed and presented the strategic transformation plan to Private Equity stakeholders. Delivered board-level presentations on performance, restructuring, and growth — and communicated directly with executive leadership and ownership on financial performance, retail restructuring, revenue model evolution, and the roadmap for a modern retail operating model.

SaaS Telecommunications Client — Video Communication Software · 12-month engagement

Led the end-to-end commercial transformation of an early-stage SaaS company, evolving it from a product-centric platform into a scalable, revenue-driven, service-based business with partner-led distribution.

- Go-to-market & positioning. Led full redesign of go-to-market strategy, repositioning the platform as a customer communication and engagement solution. Defined target segments across enterprise, SMB, and direct-to-consumer channels; built ROI-driven messaging frameworks.
- Pricing & revenue architecture. Architected a scalable tiered SaaS pricing model with free-trial entry tier to reduce acquisition friction and accelerate onboarding. Built conversion and expansion pathways from free to paid to premium — supporting predictable ARR growth and strong unit economics.
- Strategic partnerships. Identified, secured, and scaled integration-led partnerships with Zendesk, Aircall, and other communication ecosystems — embedding the product within partner environments and establishing partner-level distribution agreements.
- Partner revenue enablement. Worked directly with Zendesk sales, partnership, and customer success teams to operationalize revenue within their installed base. Trained teams on solution positioning and built cross-sell/upsell frameworks across Canada, the US, Europe, and the UK.
- Investor readiness. Developed and delivered executive presentations and pitch decks. Positioned the growth narrative for next-stage seed funding. Delivered 30% ARR growth and a service-based, partner-distributed revenue model.

CROSS-PORTFOLIO IMPACT

- Across engagements — Redesigned commission structures and operating workflows for multiple retail and SaaS clients to improve sales engagement and field performance. Introduced live video sales technology that increased annual gross revenue by 176% for a key client.

Canadian Appliance Source (CAS) National (HQ Toronto, ON)

President of Sales 2014 – 2022

Joined as a Store Manager and was promoted through Director of Sales (5 locations) to President of Sales, leading national sales operations across 36 locations spanning Ontario, Quebec, Nova Scotia, Manitoba, Saskatchewan, Alberta, and British Columbia. Reported directly to the President; member of the executive leadership team alongside the CFO and CTO.

- Market share & scale. Helped grow the business from a sub-1% share of the Canadian appliance market to 8.8% national share — taking the company from a six-figure regional operator to a mid nine-figure national platform, expanding from 3 to 36 locations along the way. Held full national sales accountability throughout.
- Sales infrastructure. Designed the company's sales operating system from the ground up: SOPs, structured sales journey, closing frameworks, follow-up cadences, and lead-routing automation. Drove a 57% national close rate.
- Team leadership. Recruited, developed, and performance-managed 300+ sales professionals and regional leaders. Built leadership layers from store-level to national, supporting rapid hiring during scale.
- Training & enablement. Personally delivered early-stage sales training across the company; later built a vendor-integrated training ecosystem with virtual onboarding, product certifications, and structured manufacturer store visits.
- Vendor & contract management. Direct liaison with 20+ appliance and furniture manufacturers. Negotiated contracts, pricing, MDF allocations, and rebate programs. Reduced financing costs by 3.6%.
- Omni-channel innovation. Designed and launched a national omni-channel sales model. Repositioned live chat as a primary sales channel (200%+ growth, nine-figure revenue stream) and built a video-based remote selling platform (seven-figure channel) — among the first of its kind in Canadian appliance retail.
- New revenue divisions. Built the Trade Incentive Program (designers, custom builders, property managers) from \$0 to eight figures. Launched the Commercial Division (high-rise, mid-rise, infill, tract builders) from \$0 to \$5M in 8 months, scaling to eight figures.

- Private label & global sourcing. Designed an exclusive private-label appliance line (ventilation hoods, ranges, refrigeration) with overseas manufacturing partners — defining specs, cost structure, pricing, and volume planning.
- Showroom & expansion strategy. Led national retail expansion: market identification, site selection, lease negotiation, financial viability, and full showroom buildouts — including layout, customer flow, vendor-funded display programs, and standardized merchandising across all 36 locations.
- Marketing & promotion. Directed all national marketing — print, radio, billboard, digital, in-store events. Controlled and deployed a \$10M+ annual marketing budget aligned to inventory turnover, traffic, and conversion.
- Technology & systems. Partnered with IT to design POS architecture, automated product tagging, lifecycle management, and a centralized markdown system enabling company-wide price resets in a single action.
- Logistics oversight. Directly managed home delivery operations in Ottawa and Montreal — routing, scheduling, and throughput optimization.
- Mergers & acquisitions. Participated in evaluation and integration of acquisition targets — aligning operations, integrating sales teams, and standardizing processes.
- Executive contribution. Active participant in C-suite strategy on national expansion, pricing architecture, technology investment, and vendor strategy. Functioned as the bridge between executive intent and field execution.

Dufresne Furniture & Appliances Ontario, Canada

General Sales Manager 2011 – 2014

Led sales and operations in a high-ticket furniture and appliance environment across multiple locations.

- Team development. Recruited, trained, and developed a high-performing sales team that consistently exceeded targets. Conducted ride-alongs, daily activity coaching, and structured performance management.
- Profitability. Conducted in-depth margin analysis, implemented pricing strategies, and optimized store layouts to improve profitability and conversion.
- Customer experience. Enhanced client relations through improved service initiatives and innovative in-store displays — increasing foot traffic and conversion.
- Marketing. Developed and executed local marketing campaigns that lifted brand awareness and market share.

Evanov Radio Group / Astral Media Ontario, Canada

Account Manager 2008 – 2011

Radio advertising sales — sold airtime and integrated campaigns across a portfolio of 50+ retail, commercial, and service-based clients in local markets. Built campaigns designed to drive foot traffic, phone inquiries, and revenue for clients ranging from small independents to large multi-location operators.

- Portfolio & territory. Managed and grew a book of 50+ active clients across local markets, ranging from independent retailers to multi-location commercial operators.
- Audience-driven campaign design. Built campaigns around the demographic and psychographic profile of each station's reach — matching the right client, the right offer, and the right airtime to drive measurable foot traffic and inbound call volume.
- Consultative, in-person selling. Sold face-to-face — built and delivered tailored presentations directly to C-level executives, directors, and owner-operators. Translated marketing objectives into media plans, creative concepts, and ROI-driven recommendations.
- Deal range & negotiation. Closed contracts spanning the full spectrum — from small local buys of a few thousand dollars to integrated annual campaigns of \$100K+ — handling pricing, packaging, and contract negotiation end-to-end.
- Pipeline & follow-up discipline. Built and maintained a structured pipeline through prospecting, discovery meetings, proposal development, and disciplined follow-up — consistently exceeding quota.
- Cross-functional execution. Partnered with creative, production, and media teams to develop and launch integrated campaigns that lifted client visibility, traffic, and brand recognition.

The Brick Ontario, Canada

Sales Associate → Sales Manager → Store Manager 2003 – 2008

Joined as a Sales Associate in a high-volume furniture, electronics, and appliance retail environment. Advanced through Sales Manager (youngest in The Brick's history at time of promotion) into Store Manager — running full-store P&L by the end of tenure.

- Rapid advancement. Promoted to Sales Manager within an 'A'-classification store generating \$20M+ annually — the youngest Sales Manager in The Brick's history at time of promotion.
- Sales leadership. Closed difficult and high-value transactions; trained, coached, and developed sales staff; participated in hiring and scheduling; monitored KPIs and drove conversion across the sales floor.
- VIP program leadership. Helped create and launch the VIP sales event program with the Regional Manager — sourcing certificates, building the operational framework, and piloting the model in the first Canadian store. The VIP event format later rolled out successfully nationally.
- 'Road Wars' business development. Organized and led 'Road Wars' BD campaigns — personally driving staff into local businesses to invite owners and employees to VIP events. Generated meaningful local traffic and event participation.

- Store Manager — C-to-B turnaround. Promoted to Store Manager of a 'C'-classification store and grew it to a 'B'-classification location through team development, operational discipline, merchandising strategy, and improved sales execution. Held full P&L responsibility — staffing, scheduling, deposits, hiring, layout, and product selection.

EARLY CAREER

RadioShack / InterTAN Canada — Wireless Sales → Sales Associate → Assistant Store Manager · ~3 years

- Progression — Progressed from Rogers Wireless retail kiosk sales (cell phones, plans, accessories, activations) to consumer electronics Sales Associate (computers, televisions, audio, warranties), then to Assistant Store Manager — supporting scheduling, cash handling, inventory ordering, and floor supervision. Established the early consumer-electronics, telecom-sales, and store-operations foundation that informed later career progression.

Kmart Canada / Zellers — Cashier → Front End / Customer Service Leadership · 1996 onward

- Foundations — Started as a Cashier in a high-volume retail environment; promoted into Front End / Customer Service leadership — managing cashier teams during evenings and weekends, overseeing the customer service desk, resolving escalations, promoting HBC and Zellers credit cards, and managing layaway accounts. Also worked seasonal full-time across Electronics, Fashion, and Hardgoods departments — gaining early merchandising, planogram, and cross-department exposure that informed later showroom and retail operations work.

LEADERSHIP PHILOSOPHY

Strategy is only valuable if it survives contact with the field. My approach is to translate executive intent into systems — playbooks, KPIs, training, and accountability — so that performance becomes repeatable rather than personality-dependent. I lead with a bias toward measurable outcomes, disciplined execution, and respect for the people doing the work in the showroom, on the phone, and in the customer's home.